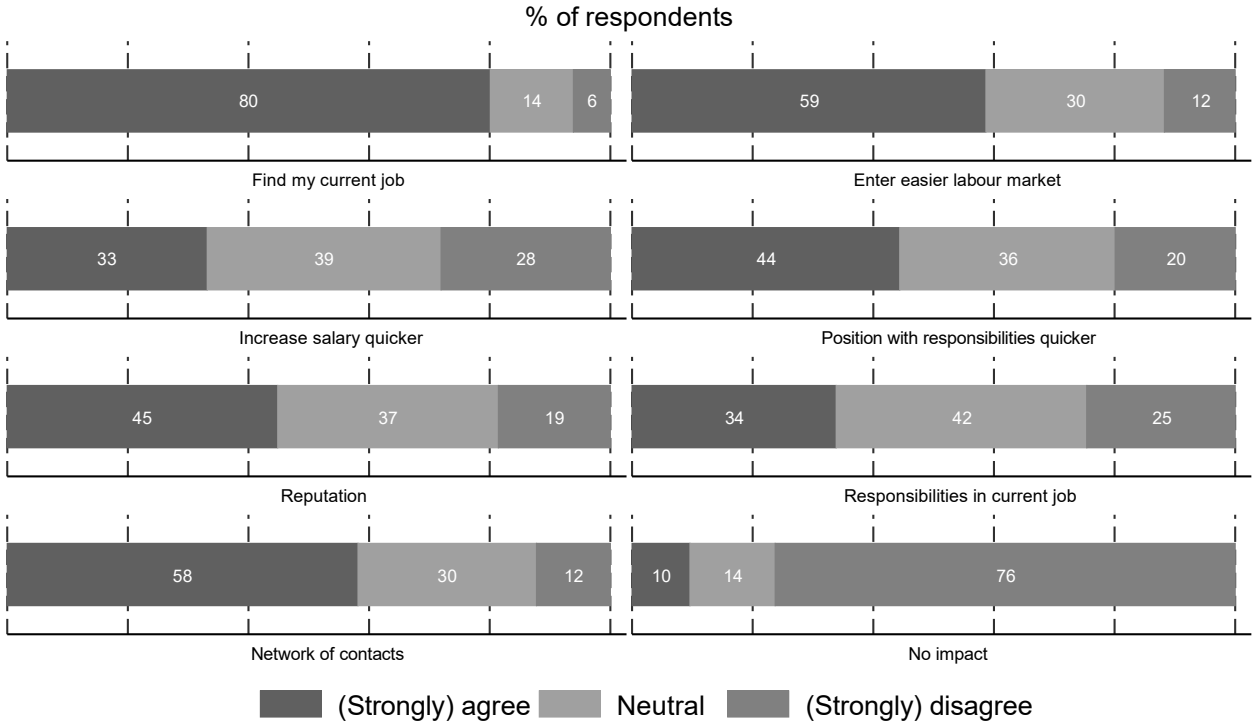
Germany	22	11%
France	16	8%
United States	15	8%
United Kingdom	14	7%
Italy	11	6%
Netherlands	9	5%
Austria	8	4%
Spain	8	4%
Poland	7	4%
Sweden	7	4%
Norway	6	3%
Canada	4	2%
Portugal	3	2%
Other countries	21	11%
No answer	-	-

Source: authors' elaboration. **Note:** 196 answers analysed. Organisation and firm size are defined based on the number of employees: micro firms have fewer than 10 employees, small firms have between 10 and 49 employees, medium firms have between 50 and 249 employees, and large firms have 250 or more employees. Refer to Table B.1 in Annex B for additional statistics on the target sample composition.

We argue that the experience at CERN contributed to getting the ECRs' occupation and, therefore, the associated wage. The survey responses appear to support this hypothesis (Figure 6). Most of the ECRs stated that their learning experience at CERN helped them find their current job, enter the labour market, and expand their professional network. Additionally, they indicated that their time at CERN facilitated obtaining a position with greater responsibilities more quickly, which had a positive impact on their wages. Only a few cases showed no contribution of CERN training to their career development.

Figure 6. Contribution of research training at CERN to ECRs' professional career.



Source: authors' elaboration. Note*:* 196 answers analysed. Multiple answers question. Question C.7 of the questionnaire: "For each of the following statements, indicate your level of agreement. My experience at CERN helped me…". Respondents were asked to indicate their answer on a five-point Linkert scale (Strongly disagree, Disagree, Neutral, Agree, Strongly Agree). In the chart, the option "Agree" groups the original options "Strongly Agree" and "Agree" while "Disagree" groups the original options "Strongly disagree" and "Disagree". Refer to Table B.2 in Annex B for further details on the question items.

The observed average yearly gross salary in our sample is EUR 77,401, ranging from a minimum of EUR 6,250 to a maximum of EUR 430,000. Figure B.2 in Annex B shows its log-probability distribution function, while Figure B.3 shows the salary distribution by country of employment. We also asked respondents to indicate the type of contract, [22] whether they received an extra bonus (monetary and in-kind) in addition to salary, which was the case for 51% of ECRs (*n = 101*)[23] and the type of contract with most of the respondents having a full-time contract (*86%; n=168*) (Table B.1, Annex B).

[22] Question B.14 of the questionnaire: "Your labour contract", with options: (i) full-time; (ii) part-time; (iii) temporary contract; (iv) fixed-term contract; (v) seasonal contract; (vi) causal contract and zero hour; (vii) volunteer; (viii) Apprentices.

[23] Question B.12 of the questionnaire: "Do you receive some extra bonus/benefits in addition to your salary?" with options "Yes" and "No", while question B.13: "Your extra bonus is", with options: (i) Monetary; (ii) In-kind (meal voucher, healthcare voucher, etc); (iii) Both monetary and in-kind.

4.2 Econometric analysis

We developed a comprehensive set of variables for the econometric analysis by using the survey items (Table 6).

Table 6. Econometric analysis: list of variables

Survey items	Label (in the model)	Description (as used in the model)
Current total yearly gross salary	Salary	Hourly gross salary (log)
Number of years spent in formal education	Education	Numbers of years of formal education (log)
Number of years you have been working since the period at CERN ended	Work experience	Number of years of working experience (log)
Other training experiences beyond CERN	Other training	1 if yes, 0 otherwise
Gender	Male	1 if male, 0 otherwise
Age as 2021	Age	Age as of 2021 (log)
Items related to the period at CERN		
Motivation to apply to CERN	Environment, Knowledge, Skill, Job Chance	Set of dummies for each level of the liker scale (from 1 "Not important / Low importance" to 3 "Very Important/ Important ")
Start/end – date of the training period at CERN	Duration of the CERN training	Duration in months (log)
Skills-related items	No. of hard skills	Number
	No. of soft skills	
Activity domain when at CERN	Activity domain when at CERN	Set of dummies
Salary-related items		
Type of contract	Full-time contract	1 if full-time, 0 otherwise
Recipient of extra bonus in addition to salary	Bonus	1 if yes, 0 otherwise
Context-related items		
Size of the company/organisation	Micro	1 if micro, 0 otherwise
	Small	1 if small, 0 otherwise
	Medium	1 if medium, 0 otherwise
	Large	1 if large, 0 otherwise
Sector of employment	Industry & finance	1 if yes, 0 otherwise
	Academia & research	1 if yes, 0 otherwise
	Public ad, incl. non-profit	1 if yes, 0 otherwise
Country of employment	Country names	For each country: 1 if yes, 0 otherwise

Source: authors' elaboration